

Ostrom 1990 RG Notes

Ostrom, Elinor. *Governing the Commons: The Evolution of Institutions for Collective Action*.

London: Cambridge University Press, 1990.

1 Main Idea

2 General Notes

- Tragedy of the commons occurs without supporting institutions; when CPRs are properly managed by means of institutional development, the tragedy can be avoided. Leviathan solution is not optimal for this use case
- Best solution to the commons is the establishment of self-organized and self-governed institutions – those who are subject to the resource and its usage should create them to manage
- Communication, monitoring, customization, and enforcement are all necessary traits of collective action solutions
- Institutional construction is a costly endeavor, creating an additional potential collective action problem – easier to let someone else take the initiative of institutional design
- Potentially actually most appropriate as a lens of institutional endogeneity rather than as a substantive application?

3 Important Specific Factual Claims

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4 Connections

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5 My Critiques

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